

# SITE-SEEING

- 1 **SHAADI.COM:** Oldest, celebrated millionth match last year
- 2 **BHARATMATRIMONY.COM:** Has maximum educated profiles
- 3 **JEEVANSATHI.COM:** Fastest growing site, popular in north India
- 4 **SIMPLYMARRY.COM:** Targetted at the 25-30-age band in the metros
- 5 **IDONTWANTDOWRY.COM:** Smartly positioned as a social crusader
- 6 **SECONDSHAADI.COM:** Good business out of India's climbing divorce rate
- 7 **BPOSHAADI.COM:** World's only; allows BPO workers to pair up
- 8 **1RUPEEMATRIMONY.COM:** Pay Re 1-a-day and fish out your life partner
- 9 **KLASSICMATCH.COM:** Promises to pair up children of VIPs and VVIPs
- 10 **POSITIVESAATHI.COM:** India's first marriage site for HIV-positive people

## HANDY TIPS

- Don't get into the paid membership mode right after enrolling yourself in a matrimonial portal
- Use their free service and check out if the profiles fit into your idea of a mate to a T
- Keep your profile up-to-date and complete, without giving away your contact details
- Maintain an album of decent photographs in various settings
- Show your personality, instead of listing up boring attributes
- Fill in the Partner Profile for a sharper search; save yourself from browsing unwanted profiles
- Take the initiative. Make the first move if you find a profile interesting.

## INSTANT SYNERGY: CLINTON GOVEAS



SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE

"My friends, after they heard my story, have started looking for partners online."

**HE IS:** A senior product manager with one of India's top Internet companies

**FOUND:** His dream partner 3,000 miles away after years of surfing, IM chats and social networking

**PARENTS:** Started bride-hunting; he decided to take the lead

**BELIEVES:** Internet is making the youth much more involved in finding partners

**ENGAGED:** In September 2007

**THE STORY:** If someone had told Goveas that two people could fall in love from the first email, he would have said, "Impossible". When it happened to him, it was instant synergy on cyberspace. Finally, they informed their parents.

## 70% Men want wives between age 26 and 35

meet each other and to converse without fear". It's also an "empowering" tool for women as it cuts down her need to wait for someone else to arrange her marriage, or for the groom to visit several brides before making his choice. "It gives women...the choice to make friends from members of the opposite sex."

Clearly, the golden age of online mating is on us. Just ask the executives of shaadi.com, which reports 50 successful matchmakings a day. Or look at bharatmatrimony.com, where you'll get the maximum number of educated profiles. jeevansathi.com gets 119 million page views. Or just talk to any young single person: "How many of your friends have used or are currently using online matchmaking services?" The answer, more often than not, would be, "Pretty much all of them." According to a new survey by JuxtConsult, "all of them" actually translates into 12 million people—half of urban India's Net users.

Mix biology and economy in equal measure; add a dash of family values;

omit romance; overcook the base of practicality; thicken it with religion and caste; stir in stars and planets—that was always the short and sweet recipe for arranged marriages in India. Finding a mate was far too important a business to be left to those actually getting married. Assisted by relatives, astrologers and matchmakers, parents controlled the mating rituals. Candidates were expected to float with the tide. But the proliferation of matrimonial sites and the growing number of users point to a new mindscape.

A survey, *Changing Preferences of the Indian Youth* on 2,000-plus men and women across urban India by shaadi.com provides new clues. For 46 per cent men and women, horoscope-matching in finding their life-partners is irrelevant; 51 per cent fly in the face of tradition by voting for intercaste marriage. Over 61 per cent men want women with advanced degrees and 48 per cent opt for working wives. Nearly 68 per cent women root for metro partners and 68 per cent voice their intent to work post-marriage. "The youth today